

Inference - Workbook 1

Build inferences from multiple details, then check the evidence.

Strategy reminder

Clues + reasoning = inference. Choose the smallest conclusion that explains the clues. Then verify every important word against the passage.

The Returned Badge

Text 1

On Monday, Priya found a staff badge beside the copier. She placed it in a labeled envelope at the reception desk and emailed the office team to say where it was. On Tuesday morning, she noticed the envelope was gone and a short thank-you note had been left in its place.

1. What can the reader most reasonably infer?

- A. The badge likely reached its owner
- B. Priya threw the badge away
- C. The copier caused the badge to fall
- D. The office stopped using badges

2. Which detail most strongly supports that inference?

- A. The badge was near a copier
- B. The envelope was gone and a thank-you note appeared
- C. Priya worked on Monday
- D. The desk had labels

The Quiet Prototype

Text 2

During a design review, Jonas usually talks through every change he makes. This time, he set a new prototype on the table without explaining it. When a teammate asked whether the hinge problem had been fixed, Jonas turned the model over, tested the hinge twice, and smiled before asking the teammate to try it.

3. What can be inferred about Jonas?

- A. He is confident that the hinge improvement works
- B. He forgot what the prototype is for
- C. He refuses to let others touch the model
- D. He plans to abandon the project

4. Which detail best supports the inference?

- A. Jonas usually talks through changes
- B. The model is on a table
- C. He tests the hinge, smiles, and asks the teammate to try it
- D. A teammate asks a question

The Empty Shelf

Text 3

A neighborhood pantry keeps rice, canned vegetables, and soap on three labeled shelves. On Friday afternoon, the rice shelf was empty even though the pantry had received a shipment on Thursday. A volunteer found several unopened rice boxes stacked beside the back door with a note that read, "Please count before shelving."

5. What can the reader infer about why the rice shelf is empty?

- A. The rice has likely not been counted and shelved yet
- B. The pantry stopped accepting rice
- C. All rice was distributed Thursday night
- D. The boxes are empty

6. Which detail most strongly supports the inference?

- A. The pantry has three shelves
- B. The rice boxes are unopened beside a note saying to count before shelving
- C. Soap is also stored at the pantry
- D. Friday is after Thursday

Review your reasoning

Before checking the key, mark the question that felt hardest. Write one clue that changed your mind and name the distractor that was most tempting.

Answer key and reasoning

1. A - The missing envelope plus thank-you note strongly suggests someone recovered the badge.

Watch for: Do not invent exactly who picked it up when the text does not say.

2. B - That change is the clearest evidence that the badge was collected.

Watch for: Choose evidence that directly points to the inference, not background.

3. A - Testing the hinge, smiling, and inviting a teammate to try it all suggest confidence in the fix.

Watch for: Use the cluster of actions, not one word.

4. C - Those actions directly show his reaction to the hinge performance.

Watch for: Background habits can help set contrast, but the strongest evidence is the response to the prototype.

5. A - The unopened boxes and instruction to count before shelving explain why stock is present but not on the shelf.

Watch for: Prefer the inference that uses all clues with the fewest assumptions.

6. B - The location and note directly explain the delay in shelving.

Watch for: Chronology alone is weaker than evidence of a required unfinished step.